

SENATE BILL 1819

By Campbell

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49,
relative to civics engagement.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 6, Part 4, is amended by
adding the following as a new section:

(a) Each public high school shall provide students who are enrolled in a United States government and civics course with three (3) civic engagement field days, one (1) for each of the three (3) distinct branches of government. A civic engagement field day required pursuant to this subsection (a) must:

(1) Include structured learning activities aligned with the state board-adopted academic standards for the United States government and civics course; and

(2) For purposes of the civic engagement field day that covers the:

(A) Legislative branch, include a class visit to a city council, county commission, or the general assembly;

(B) Judicial branch, include a class visit to a courthouse to allow students to observe a judicial proceeding or to meet with a judge or court official; and

(C) Executive branch, include a class visit to the office of a mayor, county executive, or to the office of the governor.

(b) If a high school student who is enrolled in the United States government and civics course is absent from school on the day for which a class visit described in

subdivision (a)(2) occurs, then the public high school is not required to reschedule the class visit or arrange for a separate visit for the absent student.

(c) A public high school may prohibit a student who is enrolled in the United States government and civics course from attending a class visit described in subdivision (a)(2) for disciplinary reasons in accordance with the disciplinary policy of the LEA or public charter school.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to the 2026-2027 school year and each school year thereafter.